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BJØRN MO FORUM

Work Experience

01.2023–present

Doctoral Research Fellow

Department of Political Science at the University of Oslo. With 25% teaching obligation. Participant in the research project: The Political Executive: Cabinet Government Praxis Between Laws and Norms (POLITEX), PI: Jostein Askim. Researching politicization of bureaucracy and governments appointment power – as well as cabinet decision-making in parliamentary democracies more generally. Thesis: Expected hand-in December 2026.

04.2026–06.2026

Visiting Scholar

KU Leuven Public Governance Institute. Liaison Professor: Marleen Brans.

01.2025–07.2025

Visiting Student

Department of Political and Social Sciences at the European University Institute. Liaison Professor: Simon Hix.

06.2022–12.2022

Research Assistant

Department of Political Science at the University of Oslo. Research project: The Political Executive: Cabinet Government Praxis Between Laws and Norms (POLITEX), PI: Jostein Askim. Tasks: data collection, analysis and visualization, literature searches, and developing a PhD research proposal.

10.2021–04.2022

Higher Executive Officer

Department of Employer Policy in the Ministry of Local Government and Regional Development. Working in the secretariat of the Top civil Servant Remuneration System Committee (Lederlønnsutvalget). Tasks: assisted in carrying out 20 semi-structured interviews with top civil servants. Had the main responsibility for designing, distributing and analyzing a survey of 200 top civil servants.

10.2020–12.2021

Research Assistant

Department of Political Science at the University of Oslo. Research project: Public leadership, organizational performance, and trust in government (PART), PI: Tobias Bach. Tasks: Data collection, coding and statistical analysis in R.

02.2021–04.2021

Internship Trainee

Department of Employer Policy in the Ministry of Local Government and Modernization.

Education

08.2020–06.2022	University of Oslo Master in Political Science (120 ECTS). GPA: A/B 4.71/5.00. Specializing in quantitative methods, comparative politics and public policy & administration. Wrote my master's thesis (45 ECTS) on the politicization of top civil servants in Norwegian ministries 1884-2021.
06.2019–08.2019	London School of Economics and Political Science Summer school (15 ECTS). Subjects in international relations.
08.2017–06.2020	University of Oslo Bachelor in Political Science (180 ECTS). GPA: A/B 4.48/5.00. Specializing in the European Union, international organizations and quantitative methods. Supporting subjects in economics and history.

Research

Journal Articles

1. Forum, B. M. (2026). Bureaucratic Turnover Under New Governments: The Moderating Effect of Bureaucratic and Political Layering. *Journal of Public Administration Research and Theory*, 36(4), 429–446. <https://doi.org/10.1093/jopart/muag016>
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Book chapters

1. Forum, B. M. (2027). Norway: Two Career Paths in a Dyadic Executive Structure. In *The Palgrave Handbook of Careers in the Executive Triangle*, edited by Jan-Hinrik Meyer-Sahling, Tom Bellens, Anne Bellon, Levent Demirelli, Pierre Squevin, Fanni Tóth, Sylvia Veit, and Kutsal Yesilkagit. Palgrave.
2. Rasch, B.E., Forum B. M. & Bucur C. (2026). Parliamentary institutions and portfolio allocation in coalition governments. In *Democracy at the Crossroads – Challenges for Governance and Representation: Essays in Honour of Thomas Saalfeld*, edited by Jorge M. Fernandes and Javier Martínez-Cantó. Routledge.
3. Bach, T., Forum, B. M., & Hesstvedt, S. (2025). Norway: Formal and informal politicization in a merit bureaucracy. In *Handbook of Politicization and Political Patronage*, edited by B. Guy Peters, Colin Knox, Francesco Panizza, Conrado Ramos, and Katarína Staroňová. Edward Elgar Publishing.
4. Askim, J., Forum, B. M., & Tranøy, B. S. (2024). The party politics of policy endurance: parliamentary settlements in Norway, 1980-2021. In *Pathways to Positive Public Administration*, edited by Patrick Lucas, Tina Nabatchi, Janine O'Flynn, and Paul 't Hart. Edward Elgar Publishing.

Working papers

1. Forum, B. M. When Does the Cabinet Constrain the Minister? Evidence from Cabinet Deliberations on Bureaucratic Appointments in Norway 1945-1985. (presented at EGPA 2025, ECPR 2026).
2. Forum, B. M. & Hesstvedt, S. Party Representation on Government Advisory Commissions. (presented at ECPR 2024, Nasjonal Fagkonferanse i Statsvitenskap 2026).
3. Forum, B. M., Askim, J., & Mangset, M. Constraining the Prince: The Architecture of Merit-Based Recruitment. (Under review)

Conference & Workshop participation

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| 2026 | ECPR General Conference – Kraków (Poland) September 8–11. |
| 2026 | WhoGov Mini-Conference on Political Elites – Oslo (Norway) August 20–21. |
| 2026 | Nasjonal fagkonferanse i statsvitenskap. Offentlig politikk og administrasjon – Trondheim (Norway) January 6–8. |
| 2025 | WhoGov Workshop on Political Elites – Oslo (Norway) September 1–2. |
| 2025 | EGPA Conference, PSG VI: Public Personnel Policies – Glasgow (Scotland) August 26–29. |
| 2024 | ECPR General Conference (paper presenter and panel co-chair) – Dublin (Ireland) August 12–15. |
| 2024 | NoPSA XX Nordic Political Science Congress – Bergen (Norway) June 25–28. |
| 2023 | ECPR General Conference (paper presenter and panel discussant) – Prague (Czech Republic) September 4–8. |
| 2023 | ECPR Biennial Conference of the Standing Group on Regulatory Governance – Antwerp (Belgium) July 12–14. |
| 2023 | Nasjonal fagkonferanse i statsvitenskap. Offentlig politikk og administrasjon – Kristiansand (Norway) January 9–11. |
| 2022 | PAR Symposium Paper Development Workshop "Temporal Dynamics and Longitudinal Research in Public Administration" – Bergen (Norway) October 27–28. |
| 2022 | EGPA Conference, PSG III: Public Personnel Policies – Lisbon (Portugal) September 6–9. |

Scholarships and grants

- CoREx, COST Action (EUR 4000). Funding for Short Term Scientific Mission at the KU Leuven Public Governance Institute.
- Småforsk 2025 (NOK 120 000). Research grant from Department of Political Science at the University of Oslo towards project on Norwegian Cabinet Conferences (with Jostein Askim and Bjørn Høyland).

- The Research Council of Norway (NOK 149 000). Funding for Research Stays Abroad for Doctoral and Postdoctoral Fellows.
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Teaching Experience

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| 2023-2026 | Political-bureaucratic relations in the central administration (lecturer) – Graduate level, University of Oslo |
| 2023-2026 | Ministerial steering of state agencies (lecturer) – Executive Graduate level, University of Oslo |
| 2023-2024 | Introduction to public administration (seminar tutor and lecturer) – Undergraduate level, University of Oslo |
| 2024 | Digital Data in Political Science (seminar tutor) – Undergraduate level, University of Oslo |
| 2024 | Introduction to quantitative methods and research design (seminar tutor) – Undergraduate level, University of Oslo |
| 2023 | Public policy theory (seminar tutor) – Undergraduate level, University of Oslo |
| 2023 | Teaching as a PhD (student) – 20 hour post graduate course on teaching and supervision in higher education, University of Oslo |
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Supervision Experience

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| 2023-2024 | Supervisor on Master theses (3 students) – Graduate level, University of Oslo |
| 2024 | Supervisor on Bachelor theses (12 students) – Undergraduate level, University of Oslo |
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Languages

Norwegian (native), English (fluent), German (Intermediate), Dutch (Basic).